



DHC: Map Tools Tipsheet

Barnard Digital Humanities Center Handout

Class: Digital Religion

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Link to this handout: <https://tinyurl.com/dr-maps-fall26>

Overview:

This workshop is about using spatial visualizations for research. We will compare two tools, StorymapJS and Google My Maps.

Mapping Concepts:

- How do concepts of space and place resonate with your research (or not)?
- What kind(s) of argument are you making in your research?
- What story do you want to tell with this research?
- Who is your audience?
- What kind(s) historical evidence and sources are you working with?
(Examples may include text, images, videos, etc).
- How do those pieces of historical evidence relate to spatial research?
- How might that spatial research be visualized with a map?
- What shortcomings might a map have when visualizing your research?

Tools:

Both Google My Maps and StorymapJS require a **Google login**. (See the Save and Share section below with some important account considerations).

Google My Maps is a proprietary tool for creating maps with options for annotating layers with shapes, lines, and media. <https://www.google.com/maps/about/mymaps/>

- For step-by-step instructions, go to the Google documentation: [Visualise your data on a custom map using Google My Maps](#).
- If you prefer video tutorials, teacher Donnie Piercey has an [overview series](#) showing various concepts.
- Here is a sample map shared by the NYC Department of Sanitation showing [Clothing and Textile Drop-Off Sites](#)

[StorymapJS](#) is an open source tool for creating stories using slides (containing text and images) that are juxtaposed with places on the map.

- For **Instructions, FAQ, and examples**, see the StorymapJS [documentation](#).
- Additionally, the DHC has a [tutorial](#) with a breakdown of the components of a StoryMap, a guided exercise for thinking through the story you want to tell, instructions on how to make StoryMap slides, and guidance on styling your project.
- You can find some **additional examples** on the [DHC website](#).

Citing Sources and Media:

- How does each tool indicate where to put a photo credit and/or citation?
 - StoryMapJS: there is a designated spot for image/media credit and caption.
 - GoogleMyMaps: you can credit your sources or images in the text box.
- Where are good online sources for images or media that support your research?
- What aspects of your map can stand alone as research, and what might need additional context in a research paper or presentation?

Share and Save:

- StorymapJS projects must be saved *and* published; they can be shared with anyone using the Share button at top right.
- Google My Maps projects have a Share link (with a person icon) in the top left editing box.
- *Important caveats:*
 - If you use your **Barnard ID to create a Google My Map**, your work **will only be visible to members of the Barnard campus community**. To share your work publicly or with a non-Barnard audience, you would need to use a personal Gmail address.
 - If you use your **Barnard ID to create a storymap**, your work can be visible to people outside the Barnard campus community but **you can only edit/delete that project while you have access to your Barnard account**. To continue to edit your project, you would need to use a personal email address.
- Interactive maps (using either tool) can be embedded into (some) websites.
- Be sure to **save the public URL of your project** and so that you can share it and embed it into your final portfolio for this class.
- Take **screenshots** to embed into a research paper and to document the work for your records. You may also wish to record a **screencast** (video) of the project.

Help on Campus:

If you need help beyond this workshop, **email and cc both** digitalhumanities@barnard.edu AND **Z Panas** zpp2000@barnard.edu. Be sure to mention your name, class, professor, which tool(s) you are using, and what aspect you'd like help with. A DHC staff member will get back to you.